

Forklift Operator Evaluation

Audio Narration Script — English

Picking Up a Load

1. Square up on the center of the load. Position the forklift squarely in front of the load, forks centered, so the weight is balanced evenly across both forks.
2. Level the forks; then slowly drive forward until the load contacts the carriage. Tilt the forks level with the ground, then drive forward slowly and steadily until the load rests firmly against the fork carriage.
3. Lift the load carefully and smoothly until it is clear. Raise the load slowly and smoothly, just high enough to clear the ground or the stack beneath it, avoiding sudden or jerky movements.
4. Tilt the mast back slightly to stabilize the load. Tilt the mast back a few degrees so the load rests securely against the backrest and won't slide forward off the forks.
5. Look over both shoulders. Before moving, check over both shoulders for people, obstacles, or other equipment in your path.

Traveling

6. After out and stopped, lower the load to travel height. Once clear of the rack or stack and stopped, lower the load to a safe travel height, about four to six inches off the ground.
7. Do not raise or lower the load and forks while traveling. Keep the forks at a fixed height while the forklift is moving. Raise or lower the load only when stopped.
8. Maintain a safe speed. Travel at a speed that allows you to stop safely for the conditions, the load, and your surroundings. Never rush.
9. Observe all traffic rules, warning signs, floor load limits and overhead clearances. Follow posted traffic patterns, warning signs, floor weight limits, and overhead clearance markings at all times.
10. Keep arms and legs inside the forklift. Keep your arms, legs, and head fully inside the operator compartment at all times while driving.
11. Follow other vehicles at safe distance. Leave enough space behind other vehicles, about three truck lengths, so you can stop safely if they stop suddenly.
12. Slow down when cornering. Reduce your speed before turning to avoid tipping the forklift or losing control of the load.
13. Use the horn to alert others. Sound the horn at intersections, blind corners, and doorways to warn pedestrians and other operators that you're approaching.

14. Travel with the load facing uphill while on a ramp or incline. On ramps or inclines, keep the load pointed uphill. Drive forward going up and in reverse going down, so the load can't slide off.

Placing the Load

15. Stop smoothly. Bring the forklift to a gradual, controlled stop rather than braking abruptly, to keep the load stable.

16. Make sure there is sufficient clearance for the load. Before placing the load, confirm there's enough overhead and side clearance for it to fit without hitting anything.

17. Clear personnel from the area near the load. Make sure no one is standing near the placement area or under the load before setting it down.

18. Square up to the location; then stop about one foot away. Align the forklift squarely with the storage location, then stop with the load about one foot away before making final adjustments.

19. Raise the load to placement level. Raise the load to the exact height of the shelf or stack where it will be placed.

20. Move slowly forward. Ease the forklift forward slowly and steadily until the load is fully positioned in place.

21. If the load is on a pallet, lower it into position and lower the forks further. Lower the pallet gently into its final position, then continue lowering the forks slightly further so they clear the pallet openings.

22. Look over both shoulders before backing out. Check over both shoulders again to confirm the path is clear before reversing away from the load.

23. Back straight out until the forks have cleared. Reverse in a straight line until the forks are completely clear of the load and the rack.

Dismounting & Parking

24. Lower the forks to traveling position. After backing clear, lower the forks to the standard travel height, about four to six inches off the ground.

25. Fully lower the forks. Once parked, lower the forks all the way to the ground so they don't create a tripping or safety hazard.

26. Neutralize the controls. Shift the direction control and any other levers to neutral before leaving the seat.

27. Set the brakes. Engage the parking brake fully before dismounting so the forklift can't roll.

28. Turn off the power. Turn the key to the off position, or shut down the electric motor, once parked.

29. If parked on an incline, block the wheels. If you must park on a slope, place wheel chocks against the wheels to keep the forklift from rolling.

30. Park only in authorized areas. Park the forklift only in designated parking areas. Never in aisles, in front of exits, or blocking other equipment.

Safety & Housekeeping

31. Engine off. Confirm the engine or motor is completely off before walking away from the forklift.

32. Fire extinguisher nearby. Verify a working fire extinguisher is mounted on the forklift or readily available nearby.

33. Proper personal protective equipment worn. Confirm the operator is wearing all required personal protective equipment, such as a hard hat, safety vest, and steel-toed boots.

34. Safe fueling and battery recharging procedures followed. Confirm that fueling or battery charging is done in a designated, ventilated area, following proper safety procedures.

35. Spills cleaned up immediately. Confirm that any fuel, oil, or hydraulic fluid spills are cleaned up right away to prevent slips and fire hazards.

Rating Scale

For each item, rate the operator GOOD if the step was performed correctly, FAIR if it was performed but needs improvement, POOR if it was not performed safely or was skipped, or N/A if the step didn't apply to this evaluation.